

Impact of HDB Resale Portal on Property Agents

2017 to 2025

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Background

HDB Resale Portal

- Launched in Jan 2018
- Streamlines resale transactions end-to-end

Data Sources

- HDB Resale Flat Prices

(all resale transactions, monthly transaction volume & resale prices)

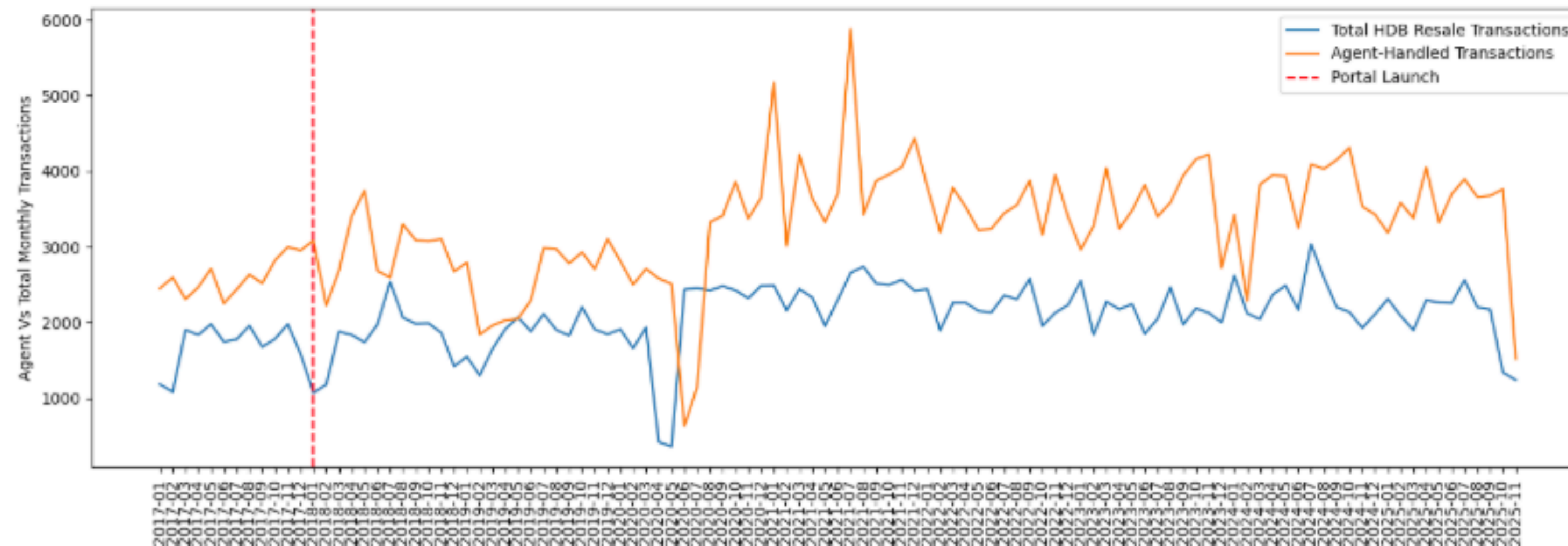
- CEA Salespersons' Transaction Records

(transactions involving registered property agents, includes agent name/role/town/transaction month)

Approach

- Compare total resale volume vs agent-handled transactions
- Compute agent market share per month

Agent vs Total Transactions

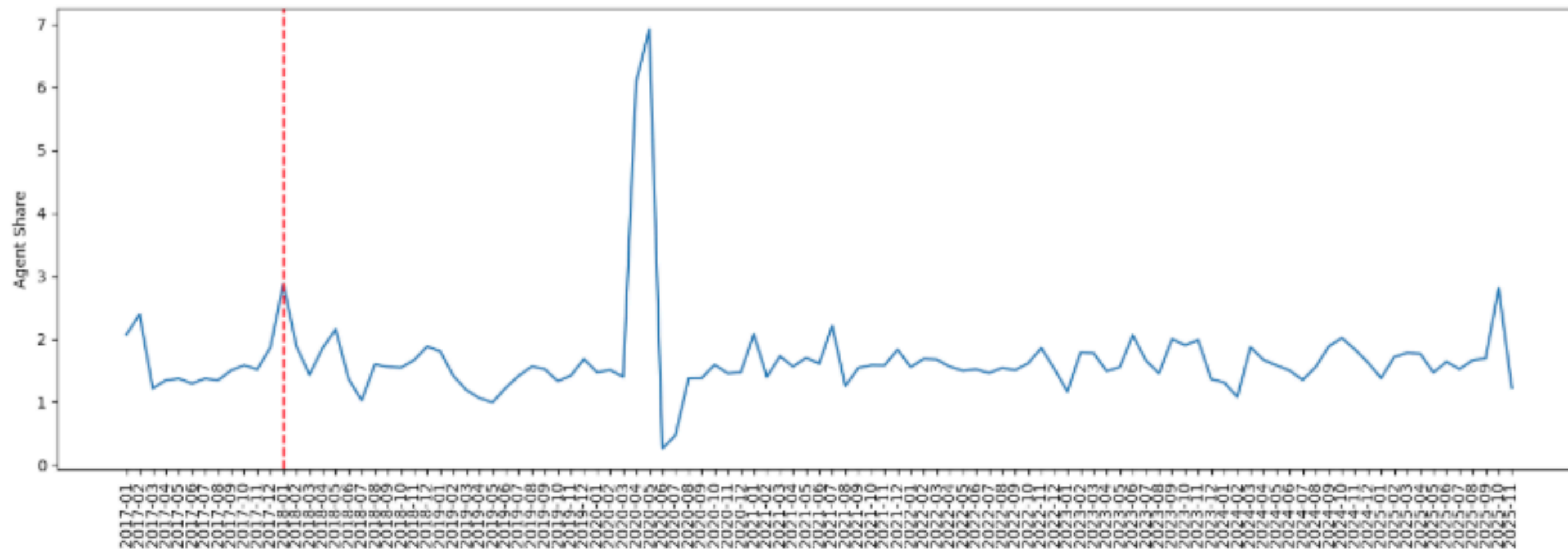


- Pre-2018: Agent-handled volume stable at 2000 - 3000 per month
- Post-2018: Significant drop in agent-handled transactions
- Decline never recovers to 2017 levels
- Total resale volume remains strong, even increasing in later years
- Gap between total vs agent-handled transactions widens over time

👉 More buyers/seller are completing resale transactions without agents

👉 Decline due to DIY adoption, not lower market demand

Agent Share Over Time



- Pre-2018 agent share: 18-25% of monthly resale transactions
- Post-2018: Agent share drops and stabilizes at a lower baseline
- Brief COVID-related spike caused by unusually low total transactions
- Long-term trend remains consistently below pre-portal levels

👉 Structural, long-term reduction in agent reliance

👉 Portal created a permanent behaviour shift toward DIY resale

Quantified Business Impact on Agents

- Decline in Transaction Volume
 - Sustained reduction in monthly agent-handled transactions
 - No recovery to 2017 levels over 7+ years
- Decline in Market Share
 - Agent share reduced from ~20% pre-2018
 - Stabilized at significantly lower levels post-2018
- Widening Gap vs Total Market
 - Total resale volumes healthy
 - Agent-handled volume diverge downward
 - Strong indicator of increasing DIY activity

What this means for Property Agents

- Agents remain relevant, but role has shifted
 - Still thousands of agent-handled transactions monthly
- Value proposition now focus on
 - Pricing advisory
 - Negotiation strategy
 - Emotional assurance
 - Complex cases